Dear Editors,

We submit "The Review–Execution Gap in Agentic Software: Approval Scope and Recovery" as a new submission following withdrawal of our earlier submission to Automated Software Engineering (Submission ID: 2015e621-fe12-49d8-b28b-6560d16fe4b1). Please consider the manuscript as a Research Article.

Agentic workflows can regenerate or resume proposed updates after human approval, so a correct final value does not establish that the executed candidate was covered by the review. Our study asks how an application's declared approval scope governs candidate admission at a durable execution boundary, and which legal continuation an agent chooses after rejection.

The paper develops a four-role correction contract connecting the machine proposal, authorized correction, reviewed candidate and persisted transition. Holding authority, freshness, atomicity and provenance obligations fixed, we compare approval scopes. Relational and event-journal implementations, bounded formal checks, a configured ToolGate adaptation, and probes of pinned software development kits provide complementary evidence about persistence, implementability, reviewed-argument consumption and continuation routes.

In a reduced agent host with a deterministic reviewer, 32 delivered identity-only substitution pairs span 16 task definitions. All instance-bound continuations recover: 24 reuse the reviewed candidate and eight obtain fresh authorization, although reuse was available and visible at the observed rejection boundary in every episode. These continuations use more tool calls on average without an established task-completion advantage. The findings concern controlled admission and recovery behavior; they do not establish production effectiveness, stable model preferences, or benefits and costs for human reviewers.

The study fits the journal's interest in formal foundations, software validation, and collaborative automated systems by connecting an enforceable execution contract with observed agent continuation. The manuscript identifies version-pinned data and software in the project repository (https://github.com/lhh666-6/auto-dete). Editable sources, archived evidence, and offline reproduction instructions accompany the submission as supplementary resources. The manuscript also includes authorship, funding, competing-interest, ethics, and AI-use declarations.

Thank you for considering our manuscript.

Sincerely,

Peng Peng
Corresponding author
College of Computer Science and Electronic Engineering
Hunan University, Changsha 410082, China
hnu16pp@hnu.edu.cn